

FATHER SOLANUS, NOTEBOOK NO. 2

Pg. 48
Cont.

the eternal value of our immortal souls - and the possibility - aye the danger of our being lost for ever. Futhermore, as Leo XIII laments, "Our lot has been cast in an age that is bitterly opposed to justice and truth." And besides all these external dangers, there is a war going on within our own hearts as determined and as uncompromising as the world conflict now raging on the fields of Europe - a war between right and wrong - between the virtues of the soul and passions of our corrupted nature. As st. Paul expresses it, the spirit warreth against the flesh and the flesh warreth against the spirit. What are we to do? "And the servants said to Him, "wilt thou that we go and gather it up? and he said no, lest perhaps in gathering up the cockle you root up the wheat also together with it." Suffer both to grow untill the harvest and in the time of the harvest I will say to the reapers, gather up first the cockle and bind it into bundles to burn; but the wheat gather ye into my barn." What are we to do then? We can not expect to root out every vestage of cockle, either from our own hearts or from society in general. As long as human society lasts there will be

Pg. 49

Bad example. Jesus Himself assures us, "It is necessary that scandals come," nevertheless, woe to that man by whom scandal cometh. What are we to do? Ah, dear Br. one thing is certain: for many reasons and in many ways we shall have to have patience. We shall have to wait till the time of the harvest which usually comes before people expect it. We shall have to wait till the day of particular judgement at least when the cockle of sin and of passion shall have been purged away and our souls tried in tribulation and sanctified in the Blood of Jesus Christ. In the mean time, however, dear Br. we must try with God's grace to realize more and more, the obstacles in the way of our salvation on the one hand and on the other our unspeakable privileges. No man can afford to be idle while waiting for harvest - the great Judgement day.